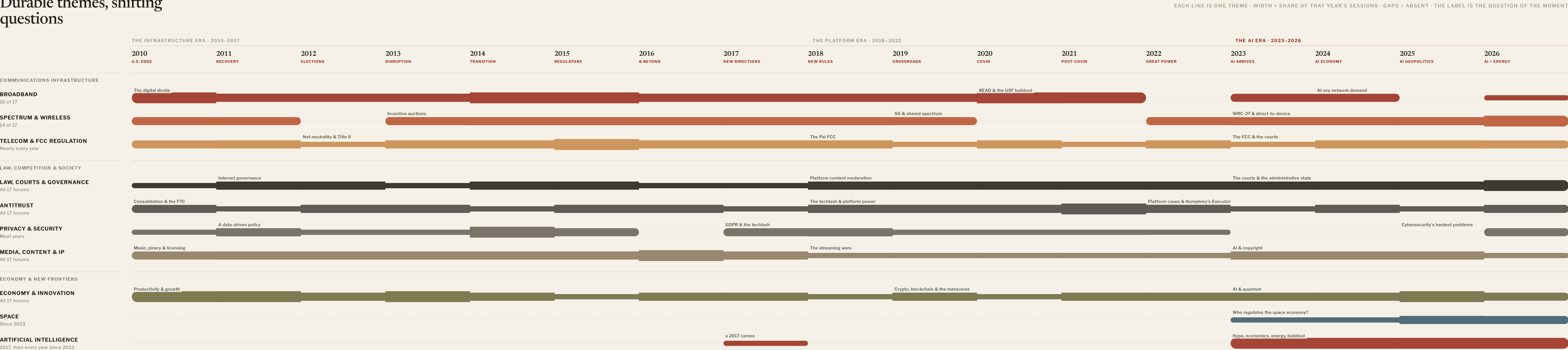


The Aspen Forum, seventeen years of the conversation

2010–2026 · SIXTEEN FORUMS DOWN, THE SEVENTEENTH THIS AUGUST

Durable themes, shifting questions

Every August, government, industry and academic leaders gather above the tree line to argue out the year in technology policy. Seventeen forums in, the striking thing is how durable the agenda is. A handful of themes – the economics of innovation, competition, communications regulation, spectrum, privacy and media – recurs in nearly every year, and only AI and space have joined as genuinely new arrivals, both since 2023. What changes is less the themes than the questions inside them. The names on the panels turn over faster than the subjects do.



Each session carries a single primary theme, an editorial call. Many recent sessions sit at the intersection of AI and a durable subject and are counted once. Line widths are approximate shares.

2010 AUG 22–24 Innovation & Critical Policy Choices: Is the U.S. Losing Its Edge? KEYNOTE Opening Keynote Carly Fiorina · Chair, TPI Board KEYNOTE Luncheon Address Reid Hoffman · LinkedIn DINNER Dinner Keynote Paul Otellini · CEO, Intel PANEL Whither Broadband Policy? Baker (FCC), Greenstein, Levin PANEL Antitrust in High-Tech Industries Bresnahan, Varian, Yoo PANEL The Internet & the Media Menell, Sherman (RIAA), Waldfoegel BREAKOUT TRACKS Wireless & spectrum · Privacy online · Smart grid	2011 AUG 21–23 Technology Policy and the Economic Recovery KEYNOTE Keynote Address Dale Jorgenson · Harvard WELCOME Welcoming Remarks Sen. Mark Udall (D-CO) PANEL Information & Privacy: A Data-Driven Policy Sen. Markey · Verizon PANEL The Internet Post-WikiLeaks, Post-Egypt McDowell (FCC), Painter (State) PANEL Online Video: Economic Implications de Sa (FCC), Israel, Ryan (Level 3) DINNER Dinner Address Peter Thiel · Clarium Capital BREAKOUT TRACKS Antitrust in high-tech · Protecting IP · Spectrum after auctions · Online drug ads	2012 AUG 19–21 Washington, Silicon Valley and the 2012 Elections KEYNOTE Keynote Address Erik Brynjolfsson · MIT Sloan WELCOME Welcoming Remarks Philip Weiser · CU Law PANEL Internet Governance Crockier (ICANN), Brown (Verizon) PANEL Internet Competition & Antitrust Athey, Bresnahan, Ramirez (FTC), Varian KEYNOTE Luncheon Keynote Gordon Crovitz · fmr WSJ Publisher KEYNOTE Keynote Address Tim Westergren · Founder, Pandora BREAKOUT TRACKS Internet economics · Copyright after SOPA/PIPA · Cybersecurity	2013 AUG 18–20 Creative Destruction and Growth: Policy Choices KEYNOTE Keynote Address Robert Crandall · TPI / Brookings LUNCHEON Luncheon Keynote Edith Ramirez · Chairwoman, FTC PANEL Deconstructing Creative Destruction Gans, Varian, Martin PANEL Competition & Internet Business Models Wright (FTC), Yoo, Quinn (AT&T) PANEL The FCC's Incentive Auctions Feld, Kwerel (FCC), Marsh (AT&T) LUNCHEON A Conversation with the Commissioners Brill & Wright, FTC BREAKOUT TRACKS Patents & IT · Copyright & the digital economy · Liberating government spectrum	2014 AUG 17–19 Tech in Transition: Policy Challenges KEYNOTE Keynote Address Tim Bresnahan · Stanford LUNCHEON "Information Rules" After 15 Years Carl Shapiro & Hal Varian PANEL Innovation & Privacy in Big Data Ohlhausen (FTC), Lieber (Google) PANEL Targeting a Secure Future Brill (FTC), Daniel (WH), Spaulding PANEL Political Economy of Telecom Reform Boucher, Weiser, Noll PANEL Copyright: Government vs Voluntary Perlmuter (USPTO), Sprigman BREAKOUT TRACKS Net neutrality / Title II · Antitrust & IP · Spectrum sharing	2015 AUG 16–18 The Government Back in Business: Revenge of the Regulators? KEYNOTE Keynote Address Tim Bresnahan · Stanford PANEL Fall and Rise of the Regulatory State Shelanski (OIRA), Rose (DOJ), Kovacic PANEL Congress & the FCC After Title II O'Reilly (FCC), Quinn (AT&T) PANEL Universal Service: Toward Broadband Levin, Rosston, Clyburn (FCC) PANEL Big Data, Privacy & the Internet of Things McSweeney (FTC), Varian, Macgillivray (WH) DINNER Dinner Keynote Kelly Merryman · YouTube, Google BREAKOUT TRACKS Music licensing · IP, standard-setting & competition · Unlicensed spectrum	2016 AUG 20–23 2016 and Beyond: Technology Policy Challenges PANEL Growth: Is the Party Over? Syverson, Haltiwanger, Corrado KEYNOTE Today's Music Marketplace Dennis Kooker · Sony Music KEYNOTE The Future of TV Laura Martin · Needham LUNCHEON Luncheon Keynote Edith Ramirez · Chairwoman, FTC PANEL The Future of Connectivity Epps (Verizon), Manner (EchoStar) PANEL The Future of Antitrust Katz, Kovacic, Manne BREAKOUT TRACKS FCC set-top box · Music licensing · Shared spectrum	2017 AUG 20–22 New Directions: Removing Barriers to Growth and Innovation KEYNOTE How We Got Rich Deirdre McCloskey · UIC PANEL AI & Automation: A Jobless Future? Bessen, Kamar (Microsoft), Varian PANEL The Internet of Things Alderfer, Rep. Issa, Young (Verizon) KEYNOTE The Political Spectrum Thomas Hazlett · Clemson LUNCH The Privacy Regulators (during the eclipse) Buttarelli (EDPS), Ohlhausen (FTC) KEYNOTE Rise of Fake News Jeffrey Herbst · Newsweek BREAKOUT TRACKS Copyright reform · Reframing spectrum · Title I vs Title II	2018 AUG 19–21 New Rules for the Digital Economy? KEYNOTE Keynote Paul Romer · NYU (2018 Nobel) FIRESIDE Fireside Chat Ajit Pai · Chairman, FCC PANEL Privacy & AI: China vs U.S. vs E.U. Brill (Microsoft), Jin, Varian PANEL Platforms Under Fire: What Rules Apply? Greenstein, Keller, White (Google) KEYNOTE Accountability for Cyberspace Charles Rivkin · CEO, MPA PANEL What Infrastructure Powers the Economy? Arbogast (Comcast), Liu Duo, Young BREAKOUT TRACKS Blockchain · Dynamic spectrum allocation · Digital inclusion & the smart city
2019 AUG 18–20 The Internet at a Crossroads KEYNOTE Opening Keynote Susan Athey · Stanford LUNCHEON Luncheon Keynote Jaron Lanier · Scientist & Author PANEL Techlash: Why & How to Respond Bambauer, Pickens, Varian PANEL How Many Gs Do We Need? (5G) Hatfield, Hazlett, Epps (Verizon) FIRESIDE An Antitrust Discussion Makan Delrahim · AAG, DOJ PANEL The Fractured Internet Alexander, Tews, Nittono (NTT) BREAKOUT TRACKS FCC/NTIA & FTC/DOJ transition teams · Blockchain · Evidence-based policymaking	2020 OCT 19–23 · VIRTUAL Tech Policy, COVID and the Election BOOK TALK How Innovation Works Matt Ridley · Author PANEL Antitrust & the FTC, Next Administration Slaughter, Wilson (FTC), Wright PANEL A Digital Cold War? China & the U.S. Sacks, Kokas, Alexander PANEL The Digital Divide: Pandemic Lessons Irving, Rosston, Mariscal FIRESIDE Fireside Chat Ajit Pai · Chairman, FCC PANEL Section 230 and the Election Fried, Givens (CDT), Goldman BREAKOUT TRACKS Five themed virtual days across privacy, antitrust, China, broadband and media	2021 AUG 15–17 How Is Tech Reshaping the Post-COVID World? WELCOME View From the State Phil Weiser · Attorney General, CO PANEL How Is the U.S. Reshaping Antitrust? Shapiro, Shelanski, Phillips (FTC) PANEL The Facebook Oversight Board Michael McConnell, Julie Owono FIRESIDE Fireside Keynote Charlie Ergen · DISH & EchoStar PANEL How to Spend \$100b on Broadband? Connolly, Rosston, Cravins PANEL Government & Science Policy Arora, Natarajan (Amazon), Cohen BREAKOUT TRACKS Content moderation · Privacy & the pandemic · Inclusive tech policy	2022 AUG 14–16 Tech Policy in an Age of Great-Power Rivalry KEYNOTE Startup Ventures in Great-Power Rivalry Fiona Murray · MIT FIRESIDE Fireside Keynote Marc Ganzi · CEO, DigitalBridge PANEL Major Developments in Antitrust Carlton, Varian, Wright, Chevalier PANEL Are the Metaverse & Web 3.0 Real? Werbach, Priam (FTC), Allen PANEL Connectivity in Ukraine Goodwin (Microsoft), Potts (Meta) FIRESIDE Fireside Chat Alan Davidson · NTIA Administrator BREAKOUT TRACKS Spectrum coordination · Privacy · Streaming	2023 AUG 20–22 AI Arrives: The Year the Conversation Changed KEYNOTE Academic Keynote Matthew Gentzkow · Stanford PANEL The Major AI Policy Questions Li (MIT), Varian, Shay (Cisco) FIRESIDE AI: Separating Hype from Reality Oren Etzioni · Allen Institute for AI PANEL The Future of Media Barnard, Martin, Brody (Fubo) FIRESIDE State Attorneys General Weiser (CO), Hill (WY) LUNCHEON Courtyard Luncheon Keynote Laurent Therivel · CEO, UScellular BREAKOUT TRACKS Spectrum · BEAD · Space · AI policy	2024 AUG 18–20 The AI Economy Takes Shape WELCOME Welcome Remarks Marc Ganzi · CEO, DigitalBridge PANEL The Economic Impact of AI Bresnahan, Corrado, Prince FIRESIDE AI & Copyright Policy Shira Perlmuter · U.S. Copyright Office PANEL New Broadband Competition Adams (T-Mobile), Schwarz (Comcast) FIRESIDE The New FTC Commissioners Ferguson, Holyoak · mod. Kovacic PANEL The Telecom Regulators Gomez (FCC), Starks (FCC) BREAKOUT TRACKS Spectrum · BEAD · Space policy · AI policy	2025 AUG 17–19 The Geopolitics of AI KEYNOTE Innovation, Ideas & Economic Growth Chad Jones · Stanford GSB PANEL AI and Energy Markets Hanna (Google), Wolak (Stanford) PANEL The Geopolitics of AI Peraut (a16z), Probasco (CSET) FIRESIDE Science, Policy & Public Trust Jay Bhattacharya · Director, NIH PANEL Future of Wireless & Global Connectivity Borje Ekholm · CEO, Ericsson FIRESIDE FCC Commissioner Anna Gomez Anna Gomez · FCC BREAKOUT TRACKS Space · Content moderation · Spectrum · Video markets · Copyright & AI	2026 AUG 16–18 UPCOMING · THIS AUGUST KEYNOTE AI Innovation, Diffusion, and the Economy Shane Greenstein · Harvard Business School FIRESIDE AI and Energy: Economist's View Severin Borenstein · Berkeley Haas PANEL Does America Lead in Quantum? Awschalom (UChicago), Parker (RAND), Rossi (Google) FIRESIDE A Fireside Chat with the FTC Chairman Andrew Ferguson · mod. Brian Sullivan, CNBC PANEL Overruling Humphrey's Executor Kallay (DOJ), Kovacic, Ohlhausen, White FIRESIDE The FCC Commissioners Gomez & Trusty · mod. Trammont BREAKOUT TRACKS WRC-27 spectrum · USF reform · States & digital regulation	Seventeen forums 2010–2026 · more than 240 sessions across ten policy themes, including keynotes, firesides, panels and breakouts. The Monday dinner was a single keynote through 2017; from 2018 it became several themed Chatham House dinners. Lines that run unbroken for seventeen years are the Forum's spine. The two that begin only in 2023 — space and AI — are the only genuinely new arrivals.